

RISE OF INDIAN CASK PROGRAMMES



BESPOKE WHISKEY CASKS ARE EMERGING AS THE ULTIMATE LUXURY COLLECTIBLE IN INDIA



DIAGEO'S INDIA RARE SPIRITS LEADS THIS REVOLUTION, OFFERING COLLECTORS EXCLUSIVITY AND PROVENANCE



INDIA'S PURCHASING POWER AND EMOTIONAL CONNECTION TO WHISKEY MAKE IT A PROMISING SEGMENT



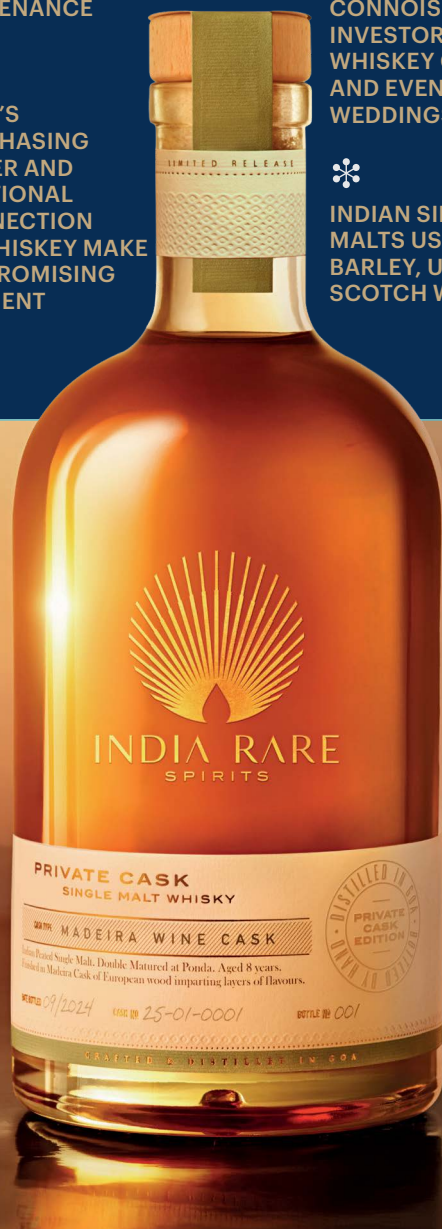
INTERNATIONAL CASK CONVERSION AVERAGES 1%, BUT IN INDIA, THE TARGET IS 2-3%



CASK PROGRAMMES ARE BROADENING INDIA'S PRESENCE ON THE GLOBAL WHISKEY MAP, ATTRACTING CONNOISSEURS, INVESTORS, WHISKEY CLUBS, AND EVEN LUXURY WEDDINGS



INDIAN SINGLE MALTS USE SIX-ROW BARLEY, UNLIKE SCOTCH WHISKIES



40,000 casks and a variety of finishes, the whiskey brand cherry-picks certain casks based on their quality. These are then sold as single casks. An unpeated, ex-bourbon cask matured for six years can start at ₹2 lakh and the final price can go upwards of ₹14 lakh.

Their programme began in 2016-17 when the first cask was sold overseas. In India, cask sales started in 2020. "Paul John Single Malt is taking the lead in developing the single malt cask programme in India. We believe we are the pioneers in the single cask programme for Indian single malts world over and in India," says Heemanshu Ashar, Global Brand Ambassador, Paul John Indian Single Malts.

Their programme touched its highest price point in India in 2024, when the Paul John Indian Single Malt Madeira Single Cask No. 1,4378, comprising 228 bottles, was sold exclusively to Avolta Duty Free at Bengaluru's Kempegowda International Airport. Bottled at 58% ABV, each bottle was priced at \$300 (approximately ₹25,000), taking the cask's overall value to nearly ₹57 lakh.

The award-winning Indian single malt Indri extends its craftsmanship beyond the bottle with their cask programme, offered from its namesake town in Haryana's Karnal district. The programme lets buyers choose from a range of casks, including ex-bourbon, ex-French wine European oak, and specialty finishes. It also offers up to ten years of storage. The programme cost covers everything from maturation and bottling to labelling.

Indian single malts are on the rise globally, bagging several top awards consistently in recent years. "There is more confidence in Indian whiskey now than ever before, including in the industry itself. Take a look at the brands producing and selling the most... Indian whiskey is only moving upwards," says Jim Murray, whiskey expert and author of the annual guide *Whisky Bible*.

The making of a fine whiskey begins on a similar trajectory anywhere in the world. The journey from grain to glass starts with barley, corn, rye, or wheat, chosen as much for quality as for character. The grains are mashed and fermented into a beer-like